



Masters Handbook

2026 – 2027

MASTERS POLICY GROUP

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Sue Warnock	)	Masters' Development Officers
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Tim Moore	)	07734 879562
Liz Austin	)	National and International
Christine Crossley	)	selection and seeding group, also
Peter Emptage	)	dealing with Worlds, Europeans, Nations
Mark King	)	Cup and McCoig Trophy.
Suzanne Brewer	)	
Phil Jones		Referee
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Masters Badminton Calendar 2026/2027 (Provisional)

		Start	Finish	Event
2026	May	10/05	-	Annual Coordinators meeting
	May	16/05	17/05	Essex Silver
	Sept	05/09	06/09	Leicester Bronze
	Sept	05/09	06/09	(East Scotland)
	Sept	19/09	27/09	Europeans
	Oct	10/10	11/10	Cumbria Silver
	Oct	17/10	18/10	Oxford Bronze
	Oct	23/10	25/10	Kent Gold
	Oct	30/10	01/11	Northumberland Silver
	Nov	07/11	08/11	(SCC)
	Nov	14/11	15/11	West of England Silver
	Nov	27/11	29/11	Nationals
2027	Jan	9/01	10/01	County Challenge
	Jan	22/01	24/01	(McCoig / Scottish)
	Jan	30/01	31/01	(SCC)
	Jan	30/01	31/01	Lancs Silver and Middlesex Silver
	Feb	13/02	14/02	Hampshire Silver
	Feb	26/02	28/02	Yorkshire Gold
	Mar	20/03	21/03	(SCC)
	Mar		-	Guernsey ?
	Apr	4/04	4/04	Championships playoffs
	Apr	16/04	18/04	All England Championships
	Apr	24/04	25/04	Championship Finals (SCC Playoffs provisional)
	May	9/05	-	Annual Coordinators meeting
	May	15/05	16/05	Essex Silver
				Nations Cup ??
	Sept	04/09	05/09	Leicester Bronze
	Sept	10/09	12/09	Nationals
	Oct	9/10	10/10	Cumbria Silver
	Oct	17/10	18/10	Oxford Bronze
	Oct	29/10	31/10	Kent Gold
	Oct	30/10	31/10	Northumberland Silver
	Nov	6/11	7/11	(SCC) ??
	Nov	13/11	14/11	West of England Silver
	Nov	28/11	5/12	Worlds (Australia)

PLEASE NOTE THIS BOOKLET WAS UP TO DATE AT THE END OF JULY AND MINOR ALTERATIONS WILL SURELY TAKE PLACE WE WILL ADVISE YOU OF CHANGES AS AND WHEN THEY HAPPEN

ALSO NOTE THAT IN THE CHAMPIONSHIPS THE WINNERS OF THE FOUR AREAS, namely

North Midlands East and West South and East SouthWest will compete at Birmingham University over the weekend 24/25th April 2027. Semi finals on the Saturday and 3rd/4th place plus Finals on the Sunday. Please make sure your players are aware of this date if you are in contention.

Play offs will be on Sunday 4th April. Venues will be announced nearer the time.

Over 40s

North	Midlands: East	Midlands: West	S&E: South	S&E: East	South West
Cheshire Lancashire Yorkshire 1 Yorkshire 2	Bedfordshire Cambridgeshire 1 Cambridgeshire 2 Lincolnshire Norfolk Suffolk	Leicestershire N.E.Wales Nottinghamshire Staffordshire Warwickshire Worcestershire	Berkshire Buckinghamshire Hampshire Oxfordshire	Essex Hertfordshire Kent Middlesex Surrey Sussex	Avon Devon Dorset Gloucester Somerset South Wales Wiltshire
Home & Away			Home & Away		

040's Midlands East and West and South East and South Play off Sunday April 4th

Over 45s

North	Midlands	S & E South	S & E East	South West
Cheshire Derbyshire Lancashire Nottinghamshire Yorkshire	Gwent Oxfordshire South Wales Warwickshire	Berkshire 1 Berkshire 2 Surrey Sussex	Essex Middlesex Norfolk Suffolk	Devon Gloucestershire Hampshire Wiltshire
	Home & Away	Home and Away	Home and Away	Home & Away

045's South and South East play off Sunday April 4th

Over 50s

North	Midlands: East	Midlands: West	South & East	South West
Cheshire Lancashire Nottinghamshire Yorkshire	Bedfordshire Cambridgeshire Essex Lincolnshire	Avon Berkshire Buckinghamshire Worcestershire	Hampshire Hertfordshire Kent Middlesex 1 Middlesex 2 Surrey Sussex	Cornwall Dorset I.O.W Wiltshire
Home & Away	Home & Away	Home & Away		Home & Away

050's Midlands East & West play off Sunday April 4th

Over 55s

North	Midlands	South & East	South West
Cheshire Lancashire West of Scotland Yorkshire	Buckinghamshire Lincolnshire Nottinghamshire Warwickshire	Essex Hertfordshire Kent Sussex	Devon Hampshire Oxford Wiltshire
Home & Away	Home & Away	Home & Away	Home & Away

Over 60s

North	Midlands	S&E: South	S&E: East	South West
Cheshire Lancashire Yorkshire	Leicestershire Nottinghamshire Shropshire Worcestershire	Buckinghamshire Hampshire Kent Middlesex Surrey Sussex	Essex Hertfordshire Norfolk Suffolk	Avon Cornwall Devon Gwent Somerset Wiltshire
Home and away	Home and away	Over 60's South and East Play off 4 th April	Home and away	

North		South	East	South West
Cheshire Lancashire 1 Lancashire 2 Nottinghamshire Shropshire Yorkshire		Hampshire Kent Middlesex Surrey Sussex	Cambridgeshire Essex Hertfordshire Suffolk Home & Away	Avon Devon 1 Devon 2 Wiltshire Home & Away

Over 65s

Over 70s

South West	Midlands	South & East	North
Avon Cornwall Devon Hampshire 1 I.O.W Somerset	Leicestershire Nottinghamshire Worcestershire Home & Away	Berkshire Essex Hampshire 2 Kent Surrey 1 Surrey 2 Sussex	Cheshire Lancashire 1 Lancashire 2 Yorkshire 1 Yorkshire 2 Home and away

Over 75s

South	North
Kent Middlesex Sussex 1 Sussex 2 Home & Away	Lancashire 1 Lancashire 2 Leicestershire Yorkshire Home and Away

South and North winners play Finals on 24th April at Birmingham University



DIVISIONS 2026/27

Over 40

Over 40 North Ties to be played Home and Away						
Cheshire						
Lancashire						
Yorkshire 1						
Yorkshire 2						
Over 40 Midlands West	Leics	NE Wales	Notts	Staffs	Warw	Worcs
Leicestershire		A	A	H	H	A
NE Wales	H		A	A	H	A
Nottinghamshire	H	H		A	H	A
Staffordshire	A	H	H		A	H
Warwickshire	A	A	A	H		H
Worcestershire	H	H	H	A	A	

Over 40 Midlands East	Beds	Camb 1	Camb 2	Lincs	Norfolk	Suffolk 1
Bedfordshire		H	A	H	A	A
Cambridge 1	A		A	H	H	A
Cambridge 2	H	H		A	A	H
Lincolnshire	A	A	H		H	H
Norfolk	H	A	H	A		H
Suffolk	H	H	A	A	A	

Midlands East and Midlands West winners to play off Sunday April 4th

Over 40 South and East - South Ties to be played Home and Away
Berkshire
Buckinghamshire
Hampshire
Oxfordshire

Over 40 South & East - East	Essex	Herts	Kent	Middlesex	Surrey	Sussex
Essex		A	A	H	H	H
Hertfordshire	H		A	A	H	H
Kent	H	H		A	H	A
Middlesex	A	H	H		A	A
Surrey	A	A	A	H		H
Sussex	A	A	H	H	A	

South Division and East Division winners to play off Sunday April 4th

Over 40 South West	Avon	Devon	Dorset	Glos	Somerset	South Wales	Wilts
Avon		A	H	A	H	H	A
Devon	H		H	A	A	H	A
Dorset	A	A		H	H	A	H
Gloucestershire	H	H	A		A	A	H
Somerset	A	H	A	H		A	H
South Wales	A	A	H	H	H		A
Wiltshire	H	H	A	A	A	H	

Over 45

Over 45 North	Ches	Derby	Lancs	Notts	Yorks
Cheshire		A	H	H	A
Derbyshire	H		A	A	H
Lancashire	A	H		A	H
Nottinghamshire	A	H	H		A
Yorkshire	H	A	A	H	

Over 45 Midland Ties to be played Home and Away
Gwent
Oxfordshire
South Wales
Warwickshire

Over 45 South West Ties to be played Home and Away
Devon
Gloucestershire
Hampshire
Wiltshire

Over 45 South and East East Ties to be played Home and away
Essex
Middlesex
Norfolk
Suffolk

Over 45 South and East South Ties to be played Home and Away
Berkshire 1
Berkshire 2
Surrey
Sussex

South Division and East Division winners to play off Sunday April 4th

Over 50

Over 50 North Ties to be played Home and Away
Cheshire
Lancashire
Nottinghamshire
Yorkshire

Over 50 South West Ties to be played Home and Away
Cornwall
Dorset
Isle of Wight
Wiltshire

Over 50 Midland East Division Ties to be played Home and Away	Over 50 Midland West Division Ties to be played Home and Away
Bedfordshire	Avon
Cambridgeshire	Berkshire
Essex	Buckinghamshire
Lincolnshire	Worcestershire

Midlands East and Midlands West winners to play off Sunday April 4th

Over 50 South and East	Hants	Herts	Kent	Middlesex 1	Middlesex 2	Surrey	Sussex
Hampshire		A	A	H	H	A	H
Hertfordshire	H		A	H	A	A	H
Kent	H	H		A	A	H	A
Middlesex 1	A	A	H		H	A	H
Middlesex 2	A	H	H	A		H	A
Surrey	H	H	A	H	A		A
Sussex	A	A	H	A	H	H	

Over 55

Over 55 North Ties to be played Home and Away
Cheshire
Lancashire
West of Scotland
Yorkshire

Over 55 South and East Ties to be played Home and Away
Essex
Hertfordshire
Kent
Sussex

Over 55 Midland Ties to be played Home and Away
Buckinghamshire
Lincolnshire
Nottinghamshire
Warwickshire

Over 55 South West Ties to be played Home and Away
Devon
Hampshire
Oxfordshire
Wiltshire

Over 60

Over 60 North Ties to be played Home and Away
Cheshire
Lancashire
Yorkshire

Over 60 Midlands Ties to be played Home and Away
Leicestershire
Nottinghamshire
Shropshire
Worcestershire

Over 60 South & East East Division Ties to be played Home and Away
Essex
Hertfordshire
Norfolk
Suffolk

Over 60 South and East - South	Bucks	Hants	Kent	Middlesex	Surrey	Sussex
Buckinghamshire		A	H	A	H	H
Hampshire	H		H	A	A	H
Kent	A	A		H	H	A
Middlesex	H	H	A		A	H
Surrey	A	H	A	H		A
Sussex	A	A	H	A	H	

South Division and East Division winners to play off Sunday April 4th

Over 60 South West	Avon	Cornwall	Devon	Gwent	Somerset	Wilts
Avon		A	H	A	H	H
Cornwall	H		H	A	A	H
Devon	A	A		H	H	A
Gwent	H	H	A		A	H
Somerset	A	H	A	H		A
Wiltshire	A	A	H	A	H	

Over 65

Over 65 North	Ches	Lancs 1	Lancs 2	Notts	Shrops	Yorks
Cheshire		H	A	H	A	A
Lancashire 1	A		A	H	H	A
Lancashire 2	H	H		A	A	H
Nottinghamshire	A	A	H		H	H
Shropshire	H	A	H	A		H
Yorkshire	H	H	A	A	A	

Over 65 South	Hants	Kent	Middlesex	Surrey	Sussex
Hampshire		A	H	H	A
Kent	H		A	A	H
Middlesex	A	H		A	H
Surrey	A	H	H		A
Sussex	H	A	A	H	

Over 65 East Ties to be played Home and Away
Cambridgeshire
Essex
Hertfordshire
Suffolk

Over 65 South West Ties to be played Home and Away
Avon
Devon 1
Devon 2
Wiltshire

Over 70

Over 70 North Ties to be played Home and Away
Cheshire
Lancashire 1
Lancashire 2
Yorkshire 1
Yorkshire 2

Over 70 Midlands Ties to be played Home and Away
Leicestershire
Nottinghamshire
Worcestershire

Over 70 South West	Avon	Cornwall	Devon	Hants 1	IOW	Somerset
Avon		H	H	A	A	H
Cornwall	A		H	H	A	A
Devon	A	A		H	H	A
Hampshire 1	H	A	A		H	A
IOW	H	H	A	A		H
Somerset	A	H	H	H	A	

Over 70 South and East	Berks	Essex	Hants 2	Kent	Surrey 1	Surrey 2	Sussex
Berkshire		H	A	A	A	H	H
Essex	A		A	H	H	A	H
Hampshire 2	H	H		A	A	H	A
Kent	H	A	H		H	A	A
Surrey 1	H	A	H	A		H	A
Surrey 2	A	H	A	H	A		H
Sussex	A	A	H	H	H	A	

Over 75

Over 75 North	Lancs 1	Lancs 2	Leics	Yorks	
Lancashire 1		H & A	H & A	H & A	
Lancashire 2	H & A		H & A	H & A	
Leicestershire	H & A	H & A		H & A	
Yorkshire	H & A	H & A	H & A		

Over 75 South Ties to be played Home and Away
Kent
Middlesex
Sussex 1
Sussex 2

MASTERS COUNTY CHALLENGE

Divisions January 9/10th 2027

Over 40 Premier	Over 45 Premier	Over 50 Premier	Over 55 Premier	Over 60 Premier	Over 65 Premier
Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at
Milton Keynes	Worcester	Milton Keynes	Worcester	Milton Keynes	Worcester
Bedfordshire	Derbyshire	Glasgow N	Hampshire	Avon	East Scotland
Cambridgeshire 1	Essex	Hertfordshire	Kent	Essex	Essex
Cheshire	Lancashire	Lancashire	Lancashire	Hampshire	Kent
Hampshire	Nottinghamshire	Middlesex 1	Lincolnshire	Lancashire	Lancashire
Middlesex	Surrey	Nottinghamshire	Surrey	Shropshire	Somerset
Staffordshire	Sussex	Surrey	Wiltshire	Surrey 1	Surrey
Yorkshire	Yorkshire	Worcestershire	W of Scotland	Yorkshire	Yorkshire
Over 40 Div 1A	Over 45 Div 1A	Over 50 Div 1A	Over 55 Div 1A	Over 60 Div 1A	Over 65 Div 1A
Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at
Worcester	Wolverhampton	Wolverhampton	Wolverhampton	Wolverhampton	Wolverhampton
Buckinghamshire	Cheshire	Cambridgeshire	Cheshire	Buckinghamshire	Cambridgeshire
Lancashire	Gloucestershire	Lincolnshire	Nottinghamshire	Cheshire	Cheshire
Leicestershire	Gwent	Wales N & E	Warwickshire	Gwent	Glasgow N
Lincolnshire	Oxfordshire	Yorkshire	Yorkshire	Hertfordshire	Lancashire
Nottinghamshire	Suffolk			Norfolk	Nottinghamshire
Wales S	Wales S			Nottinghamshire	Shropshire
Wales N & E	Wiltshire			Suffolk	Suffolk
Reserve Wales SW		Play twice	Play twice		

Over 40 Div 1B	Over 45 Div 1B	Over 50 Div 1B	Over 55 Div 1B	Over 60 Div 1B	Over 65 Div 1B
Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at
Eastleigh	Bournemouth	Bournemouth	Bournemouth	Eastleigh	Bournemouth
Avon	Berkshire	Avon	Buckinghamshire	Devon	Avon
Devon	Devon	Bedfordshire	Devon	Kent	Devon
Hertfordshire	Hampshire	Berkshire	Essex	Middlesex	Hampshire
Oxfordshire	Middlesex	Essex	Hertfordshire	Surrey 2	Hertfordshire
Surrey		Hampshire	Oxfordshire	Wiltshire	Middlesex
Sussex		Kent	Sussex		Sussex
Wiltshire		Sussex			Wiltshire
	Play twice			Play twice	

Over 40 Div 2B		Over 50 Div 2B		Over 60 Div 2B	
Playing at		Playing at		Playing at	
Bournemouth		Eastleigh		Eastleigh	
Berkshire		Buckinghamshire		Cornwall	
Cambridgeshire 2		Cornwall		Dorset	
Dorset		Dorset		Sussex	
Essex		I.O.W		Wales S & W	
Kent		Middlesex 2			
Somerset		Wiltshire			
Suffolk		Wales SW		Play twice	
Reserve Wales SW					

Over 70 Premier	Over 70 Div 1A	Over 70 Div 1B	Over 70 Div 2B	Over 75
Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at	Playing at
Worcester	Wolverhampton	Eastleigh	Eastleigh	Eastleigh
Avon	Cheshire	Devon	Berkshire	Kent
Hampshire	Lancashire 2	Essex	Cornwall	Lancs 1
Lancashire 1	Nottinghamshire	Kent	Dorset	Lancs 2
Leicestershire	Worcestershire	Somerset	I O W	Middlesex
Surrey 1		Surrey 2		Sussex
Yorkshire 1		Sussex		
Yorkshire 2	Play twice		Play twice	Play twice

MASTERS COUNTY CHALLENGE VENUES 2026/27				
Eastleigh				
040 Div 1B	050 Div 2B	060 Div 1B	OVER 60 Div 2B	070 Div 1B
Avon	Buckinghamshire	Devon	Cornwall	Devon
Devon	Cornwall	Kent	Dorset	Essex
Hertfordshire	Dorset	Middlesex	Sussex	Kent
Oxfordshire	I.O.W	Surrey 2	Wales S & W	Somerset
Surrey	Middlesex 2	Wiltshire		Surrey 2
Sussex	Wiltshire			Sussex
Wiltshire	Wales SW	Play twice	Play twice	
075 Premier				070 Div 2B
Kent				Berkshire
Lancashire 1				Cornwall
Lancashire 2				Dorset
Middlesex				I.O.W
Sussex				
Play twice				Play twice
Bournemouth				
040 Div 2B	045 Div 1B	050 Div 1B	055 Div 1B	065 Div 1B
Berkshire	Berkshire	Avon	Buckinghamshire	Avon
Cambridgeshire 2	Devon	Bedfordshire	Devon	Devon
Dorset	Hampshire	Berkshire	Essex	Hampshire
Essex	Middlesex	Essex	Hertfordshire	Hertfordshire
Kent		Hampshire	Oxfordshire	Middlesex
Somerset		Kent	Sussex	Sussex
Suffolk	Play twice	Sussex		Wiltshire

Wolverhampton					
045 Div 1A	050 Div 1A	055 Div 1A	060 Div 1A	065 Div 1A	070 Div 1A
Cheshire	Cambridge	Cheshire	Buckinghamshire	Cambridgeshire	Cheshire
Gloucestershire	Lincolnshire	Nottinghamshire	Cheshire	Cheshire	Lancashire 2
Gwent	Wales N & E	Warwickshire	Gwent	Glasgow N	Nottinghamshire
Oxfordshire	Yorkshire	Yorkshire	Hertfordshire	Lancashire 2	Worcestershire
Suffolk			Norfolk	Nottinghamshire	
Wales S			Nottinghamshire	Shropshire	
Wiltshire			Suffolk	Suffolk	
	PLAY TWICE	PLAY TWICE			PLAY TWICE
Worcester					
040 Div 1A	045 Premier	055 Premier	065 Premier	070 Premier	
Buckinghamshire	Derbyshire	Hampshire	E Scotland	Avon	
Lancashire	Essex	Kent	Essex	Hampshire	
Leicestershire	Lancashire	Lancashire	Kent	Lancashire 1	
Lincolnshire	Nottinghamshire	Lincolnshire	Lancashire 1	Leicestershire	
Nottinghamshire	Surrey	Surrey	Somerset	Surrey 1	
Wales S	Sussex	Wiltshire	Surrey	Yorkshire 1	
Wales N & E	Yorkshire	W of Scotland	Yorkshire	Yorkshire 2	
Reserves, Wales SW					

Milton Keynes				
040 Premier	050 Premier	060 Premier		
Bedfordshire	Glasgow N	Avon		
Cambridgeshire 1	Hertfordshire	Essex		
Cheshire	Lancashire	Hampshire		
Hampshire	Middlesex 1	Lancashire		
Middlesex	Nottinghamshire	Shropshire		
Staffordshire	Surrey	Surrey 1		
Yorkshire	Worcestershire	Yorkshire		



Regulations for the Badminton England Masters County Championships 2026/27

GENERAL

- 1) The competition shall be called the Masters County Championships. It will be competed for in accordance with the following regulations, or such other regulations as Badminton England, or the Masters Policy Group (hereinafter called the Committee) may from time to time determine, and the Laws of Badminton as adopted by the Badminton World Federation.
- 2) The Competition shall be open to every English county, if governed by a county association affiliated to Badminton England, the different Channel Islands and the Isle of Man if governed by an association recognised as a county association and affiliated to Badminton England, provided that the full affiliation fees are paid. Entries from associations affiliated to other National Associations may be accepted at the discretion of the Committee.
- 3) Entry forms will be circulated to counties in April and these must be returned to the Championship Secretary by the closing date stipulated on the entry form. Entry fees will be invoiced direct by Badminton England. Counties may enter more than one team in each age group. An additional fee shall be payable by those counties qualifying for the National finals

4) TERMINOLOGY

- Match Competition between one county and another
- Event A Women's Doubles. A Men's Doubles or a Mixed Doubles
- Rubber An event consisting of the best of three games of 21 points, except that
 If the score reaches 20-all, the winner is the pair with 2 clear points or whose
 Score reaches 30 first.

THE DIVISIONS AND FINALS

- 5) The country will be divided into 4 regions where possible, in which a competition for age groups over 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70 and 75 will take place (subject to sufficient entries being received). It may be necessary to split age groups within an area based on standard or geography, as determined by the Committee, taking in the views of the counties involved.
 - a) Where there are two divisions by standard the team winning Division 1 will proceed to the National finals and the top team in Division 2 will be promoted to Division 1 and the bottom team in Division 1 will be relegated.
 - b) Where regions have been split geographically, the winning teams from each section will play off on a pre-determined date to qualify for the National finals.
 - c) In the event of there being only 4 teams or less in any region, then normally they will play group rubbers at home and away, otherwise teams will compete on a home OR away basis, alternating if possible each year.
 - d) To qualify for the finals, the region winning team will be the one with the highest number of points based on:
 - e) For the Over 40,45, 50,55, 60 and 75 age groups there will be 3 points for a win, 2 points for a winning draw, 1 point for a losing draw and none for a defeat. In the Over 65 and 70 age groups there will be 3 points for a win and none for a defeat.

- i) In the case of a walkover three points will be given to the non-offending team and none to the defaulting team.
- ii) In the event of 2 or more teams having the same number of points, the winners will be decided on rubbers won to lost. If 2 counties are still tied the result of the match between them or, where home and away fixtures are played, the combined results of the matches between them will decide.
- iii) Where a match that has not been played affects the winner of a league this will be referred to the MPG to make a decision on the outcome of the final positions in the division.
- iv) Each year the age group winners will play off over a weekend for the National League title on a knockout basis. A draw will be made before the event with semi- finals on the Saturday, with the winners contesting the final on Sunday and losers competing for 3rd and 4th place.
- v) If there are only three regions in any age group, then each team will play each other.
- vi) Unless there are time restrictions the same rules apply for the finals as for the area matches.
- vii) The Referee's decision on all matters is final.

THE FIXTURES

- 6) When making fixtures the home team must offer two dates to the away team. If during the season an away team is unable to field a full team and cancels the fixture every effort must be made to rearrange the fixture, but the home side is not obliged to offer two further dates to their opponents.
 - a) If travelling distance is too great it is possible for the match to be played at a mutually agreed venue with shared expenses. Where possible teams should complete half their matches prior to 31st December and all matches by 31st March each year, except where a playoff is involved when matches must be completed at least a week before the play off date.
 - b) The dates, times and venues of all home fixtures shall be notified to the Masters Coordinator of each opposing county and the Championship Secretary by 31st August preceding the season of competition. This should be achieved by using the Confirmation of Home Fixtures Form supplied.
 - c) In an area with more than one team from an individual county (i.e., a county first and second team), these two teams **must** play each other before the 31st December. Failure to adhere to this requirement will lead to the match(es) being considered as 'Not Played' and no points will be awarded to either team.
 - d) A match should be played on at least two courts allowing 8 hours playing time per match. For Over 65 & Over 70 matches, 6 court hours should be allowed. For an Over 75 match 4 court hours should be allowed.
 - e) When a match is cancelled by the away team, and the home team can demonstrate that cancellation charges for hall hire will be incurred, then the away team may be asked to pay (or contribute towards) the cost. If a match is cancelled because of bad weather, then any costs should be shared by the two counties.
 - f) The home team is responsible for all the match expenses and should provide light refreshments.
 - g) If a fixture is postponed or rearranged the home county must advise the Championships Secretary as soon as possible and if appropriate the new date and details if amended.
 - h) Feather shuttlecocks must be used.

ELIGIBILITY of PLAYERS

- 7) All players must be eligible to play for their county under the current County Competition regulations.
- 8) If a player is playing in the Masters County Challenge, that player must play for the same county if that county enters a team of the appropriate age group within the Masters County Championships. If such a team is not entered, the player may play for another county provided that the player is otherwise eligible.
- 9) No player shall play for more than one county in the Championships during the same season of competition
- 10) A player must be a member of Badminton England and hold a current and valid Compete Membership. Players not living in England and members of another association must be registered as a non-resident.
- 11) Every player will be required to hold a Compete Membership to be eligible to represent their county within the Master's Championship. To assist counties every match can be played using one "wild card" to cover last minute non-compete players up to 31st December each year, AND from January 1st may have up to two "wild cards" for any match. The Challenge weekend will count as one "wild card". A player may only have two wild cards in a season which may be two Championship matches or one Championship match and the Challenge weekend. If that player plays again without a compete licence their games will be voided.
- 12) Players must be over the age of 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70 and 75 at the start of a match, except any over 40 team may play up to two players aged over 38 at the start of a match.
- 13) Nominations for squad members in all teams must be made before that county's first match or by 31st October, whichever is earlier. Details of subsequent players added to a squad must also be advised as soon possible to the Championship Secretary before they compete.
- 14) A player who has been nominated for a particular team may play as a reserve for other teams on three occasions in total. An 'occasion' means a Championship match; or a play-off; or the semi-final/final weekend (i.e. The semi-final and final is only considered as a single occasion).
 - a) If a player is found to have exceeded the three reserve appearances, then the scores in the first three matches will stand but the scores in any subsequent reserve appearances will be conceded to the opponents. The player will be allowed to play for the team for which he/she was originally nominated in any remaining matches.
 - b) Players will be allowed to play for two teams on the same day providing they qualify age wise and are not exceeding three reserve appearances and that it does not cause undue delay. A player nominated in a lower age group may play as often as they like in the Over 75's without effecting reserve appearances.
 - c) Where counties have 2 teams or more in an age group, at least 4 men and 4 women must be nominated prior to the start of that county's fixtures as first team players, except in the over 65 and over 70 age group, for which at least 3 men and 3 women must be nominated. For an Over 75 team two men and two ladies must be listed as 1st team players. Nominations must be sent to the Championships Secretary 10 days before that County's first rubber in that age group. Nominated first team players will be allowed to play for the second team once only, and no more than one man and one woman from the first team may play in any single second team match.
 - d) Second team players may play for the first team on two occasions but if they should play a third time they will be deemed to be part of the first team and cannot play for the second team again.
 - e) To qualify to play in the finals a player must have competed in at least two league matches or one match and a play off. In those age groups and areas where a team plays only four

matches or less a player must have competed in at least one league match or a play off to qualify to play in the finals.

- f) If a team is withdrawn after the competition has begun all fixtures played by that team shall be discounted.

THE TEAM

- 15) A team should consist of a minimum of 4 men and 4 women and with a maximum of 6 men and 6 women. An over 65 or over 70 team should consist of a minimum of 3 men and 3 women and with a maximum of 5 men and 5 women. An over 75 team should consist of 2 men and 2 ladies with a maximum of 3 men and 3 ladies.

THE MATCH

- 16) **Over 40,45,50,55,60 age groups.** A match will consist of 12 rubbers. Each team shall provide 2 men's doubles pairs, 2 women's doubles pairs and 4 mixed doubles pairs. In the men's and women's doubles events each pair of a team will play each of the opposing 2 pairs. In the mixed doubles each pair will only play their opposite number and they must play in strength order.
- 17) **Over 65 and 70 age groups.** A match will consist of 9 rubbers. Each team shall provide 3 men's doubles pairs (each man shall play twice), 3 women's doubles pairs (each woman shall play twice) and 3 mixed doubles pairs. All pairs must play in strength order, i.e., Man 1 & 2, 1 & 3, 2 & 3, Lady 1 & 2, 1 & 3, 2 & 3 followed by the Mixed again in order of strength of the pairs
- 18) **Over 75 age group.** A match will consist of 6 rubbers. There will be men's and ladies' doubles followed by 1v 1 mixed, 2 v 2 mixed and reverse. Mixed pairs must be in order of strength.
- 19) Completed team sheets should be exchanged before commencement of the match. A copy must also be given to the Referee or organiser, when requested to do so. Ineligible players must be declared before the match starts. If a team is fielding an ineligible player(s) in order to give opponents their full quota of rubbers, they must be considered as the weakest player(s) where rubbers are to be played in order of strength.
- 20) Each rubber will be the best of three games of 21 points except that if the score reaches 20-all the winner is the pair with 2 clear points or whose score reaches 30 first. This is known as the Rally Point Scoring System as under the revised Laws of Badminton as introduced by the BWF in May 2006.

Note: there shall be NO intervals when a side reaches 11 points in a game, NOR be between the first and second or second and third games.

- 21) In the event of an injury, illness or emergency in the first round of men's or women's doubles a substitute (if available) may play in the second round. An injury, illness or emergency substitution can be made for the mixed doubles providing it is done before that mixed rubber has commenced (i.e., once the first service has started).
- 22) In the event of an injury, illness or emergency in the level doubles and no reserve is available to play in the mixed, the mixed doubles rubbers will be played in the same order as decided at the outset of the rubber with no changes allowed in the pairings. The mixed rubber in which the injured player was due to play will be conceded to their opponents 21-0, 21-0.
- 23) If an injury, illness or emergency prevents a rubber being completed any points or games won by the defaulting pair shall stand with their opponents being awarded the necessary points and games to win the rubber.
- 24) A substitution can be made using a player who has played for another team on the same day provided they qualify age wise, are not exceeding three reserve appearances and that it does not cause undue delay. It should be borne in mind that even if the substitute plays only a mixed rubber it will count as a reserve appearance. Any substitution must not cause undue delay.

Players may only play in one team at the playoffs. Substitutes cannot be used from players in other participating teams. Also players may play in only one team for the finals weekend. Substitutes cannot be used from players who are playing in another team at the event.

- 25) The winner will be decided on the higher number of rubbers won. Should the match finish level on rubbers, a winning draw will be awarded to the team winning the most games; if equal then the most points and if still equal the result of the 1st mixed (see regulation 4e regarding the points awarded for draws). In the Over 65 and Over 70 age group the winner of a match will be the team winning the most rubbers.
- 26) Full results shall be submitted online within 7 days by the TEAM PLAYING AT HOME. A county failing to comply shall be fined £25 on each occasion. On the first occasion the home county does not submit the result within 7 days they will receive a written warning allowing a further 7 days before the fine is imposed.
- 27) The away county shall have a further 7 days to confirm the result. If this is not done, then it will be assumed to be correct, and the Championship Secretary will confirm the result 14 days after the fixture.
- 28) Any dispute must be raised with the Championship Secretary within 14 days of the fixture.

COMMITTEE POWERS

- 29) The Masters Policy Group shall have full powers to decide on matters not covered in the foregoing regulations and shall rule in the event of any disputes.



Regulations for the Badminton England Masters County Challenge 2026/27

GENERAL

- 1) The competitions shall be called the Masters County Challenge. They shall be competed annually in accordance with the following regulations, or such other regulations as Badminton England, or the Masters Policy Group (hereinafter called the Committee) may from time to time determine, and the Laws of Badminton as adopted by the International Badminton Federation.
- 2) The Challenge shall be open to every English county, if governed by a county association affiliated to Badminton England, the different Channel Islands and the Isle of Man if governed by an association recognised as a county association and affiliated to Badminton England, provided that the full affiliation fees are paid. Entries from associations affiliated to other National Associations may be accepted at the discretion of the Committee.
- 3) Separate challenge teams shall be run for Over 40s, Over 45s, Over 50s, Over 55s, Over 60s, Over 65s, and Over 70's and Over 75's if there are sufficient entries.
- 4) Entry forms will be circulated to counties in April, and these must be returned to the Challenge or Championship Secretary by the stipulated closing date. Counties may enter more than one team in each age group. Entry fees will be invoiced directly by Badminton England.
- 5) The Challenge will be held over the second Saturday/Sunday in January annually at various venues, to be arranged by the Challenge Organiser. Feather shuttlecocks will be used.

DIVISIONS

- 6) Teams will be placed in strength order as determined by the Committee, with a Premier Division, followed by Divisions 1A and 1B based on strength and geographical location and then 2A and 2B likewise. This is subject to entries received by Badminton England.
- 7) At the end of the season, the two lowest teams from each age group in the Premier Division will be relegated to Division 1. The top team from 1A and from 1B in each age group will be promoted to the Premier Division. The lowest team in each age group from Division 1A and from 1B will be relegated to Division 2 provided there is a relevant age group. The top team from 2A and from 2B in each group will be promoted to Division 1. However, there may be circumstances which need to be considered in respect of promotion and relegation. The Committee's decisions on these circumstances will be final.

ELIGIBILITY OF PLAYERS

- 8) All players must be eligible to play for their county under the current County Competition regulations.
 - a) If a player is playing in the Masters County Championships, that player must play for the same county if that county enters a team of the appropriate age group within Masters County Challenge. If such a team is not entered the player may play for another county provided, he/she is eligible.
 - i) A player must possess a Compete membership with Badminton England through either Club or Direct membership. Players not living in England and members of another association must be registered as a non-resident.

- ii) Every player will be required to hold a Compete Membership to be eligible to represent their county within the Masters' Challenge. To assist counties every team can use up to two "wild cards" for the whole weekend to cover last minute non-compete players. A player may only have two wild cards in a season which may be two Championship matches or one Championship match and the Challenge weekend. If that player plays again without a compete licence their games will be voided.
- b) Players must have reached, or be over, the appropriate age category on the day they are due to play. As a concession a team Over 40 may use up to two players who are Over 38 at the time of the first event.

TERMINOLOGY

- 9) Match competition between one county and another.
- Event a Women's Doubles, a Men's Doubles or a Mixed Doubles.
- Rubber an event consisting of the best of three games of 21 points, except that if the score reaches 20-all, the winner is the pair with 2 clear points or whose score reaches 30 first.

Note: there shall be NO intervals when a side reaches 11 points in a game, NOR between the first and second games, and the second and third games.

TEAMS

- 10) Each squad, in the Over 40, 45, 50, 55, and 60 squads should consist of not less than 4 women and 4 men and not more than 6 women and 6 men. Over 65, 70 and 75 squads should consist of not less than 3 women and 3 men and not more than 5 women and 5 men. Before the competition starts each team must submit the names of all its squad members to the Referee, or if one is not appointed, the appropriate Organising Committee.
- 11) Provided it does not contravene the maximum number of nominations for a squad and that they are eligible for the age groups, a player may be nominated in more than one age group. The player(s) would have to be included on both team sheets and once he/she has played he/she is committed to that team for the whole weekend.
- 12) Teams may be changed for each match within the parameters of the squad that has been nominated, as set out above.
- 13) No player may play in more than one event in any one match.
- 14) No substitution shall be permitted in a rubber at any stage once play in that rubber has commenced (i.e., once the first service has started).
- 15) If a team is unable to field a full team in a match they must try and arrange for an ineligible player to play (either a player who has not reached the qualifying age, a player playing in more than one event in that match, or a player from another county team). They must inform the referee 30 minutes before the match which event they will be forfeiting and at that time whether they are able to field an ineligible player or not. The referee will notify the opposition who shall be allowed to rightfully alter their pairings before the match starts and the 2 games of the forfeited event will be awarded to them 21-0, 21-0. The ineligible player would not be able to play the 1st mixed doubles where pairs must play in order of strength. Failure of a team to declare an ineligible player would mean a 4-0 or 3-0 defeat depending on the age group.

FORMAT OF A MATCH

- 16) The competition will be played as matches between the county teams with each team playing each of the other teams in the group.

- a) **In the Over 40s, 45s, 50s, 55s and 60s age groups** a match shall consist of four rubbers A Women's Doubles, a Men's Doubles, a 1st Mixed Doubles and a 2nd Mixed Doubles. The Mixed doubles pairs must be played in order of strength.
 - b) **In the Over 65s, 70s and Over 75s** a match shall consist of three events: A Women's Doubles, a Men's Doubles and a Mixed Doubles. The order of play shall be as above, unless otherwise agreed by the Referee, or if one is not appointed, the Organising Committee.
 - c) Pairs shall play at such time and on such court as may be specified by the Referee, or if one is not appointed, the appropriate Organising Committee.
- 17) Before commencement of each match, teams will exchange team sheets giving the eight names (or six for Over 65s and Over 70s and Over 75s and their pairings to play that match with the mixed doubles pairs, where appropriate, ranked in order of strength.
 - 18) If a rubber shall not be completed the existing score (if any) of the defaulting pair shall stand and their opponents shall be credited with the number of points and games required to win as appropriate.
 - 19) Where back to back matches occur then team sheets need to be exchanged In advance of the second match, because that match may have to start before the first one is finished. If there any injuries in the first match then the Referee may allow a direct substitution.
 - 20) The decision of a match shall be determined by the number of rubbers won. In the event of both teams being unable to field a pair for a rubber it will be deemed "not played" and neither team will be awarded the rubber or part thereof. In the Over 40, 45, 50, 55 and 60 age groups, teams will be awarded 3 points for a win, 2 points for a winning draw and 1 point for a losing draw, and 0 points for a loss. For the Over 65's, 70's and 75's teams will be awarded 3 points for a win and 0 points for a loss. In the case of a walkover 3 points will be given to the non-offending team and none to the defaulting team.

GROUP POSITIONS

- 21) The position of each team in each age group shall be determined as follows:
 - a) The winning team in each age group will be the one with the highest number of points.
 - b) In the event of 2 teams having the same number of points, the winners will be based on the result of the match(es) between them. If 3 or more counties finish with the same number of points, winners will be decided on rubbers won to lost, or games won to lost or even points won to lost..
 - c) Where sections play each other twice during the weekend then the combined results of the matches between them will decide the winner.

TROPHIES

- 22) A perpetual trophy will be awarded to the champion county in each age group of the Premier Division. The trophies will remain the property of Badminton England, which shall be responsible for insurance, but the holders shall be responsible for their care and maintenance.

GENERAL

- 23) Badminton England's current Tournament Regulations shall apply.
- 24) The Masters Policy Group shall have full powers to decide on matters not covered in the foregoing regulations and shall rule in the event of any disputes.

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The Badminton England Masters County Challenge

Past Winners

	Over 40	Over 45	Over 50	Over 55	Over 60	Over 65	Over 70	Over 75
1986	LANCS	YORKS						
1987	LANCS	YORKS	ESSEX					
1988	LANCS	MIDDX	LANCS					
1989	DURHAM	YORKS	SURREY					
1990	KENT	KENT	ESSEX					
1991	LANCS	KENT	SURREY					
1992	LANCS	KENT	ESSEX					
1993	ESSEX	KENT	NOTTS	ESSEX				
1994	LANCS	LANCS	YORKS	SURREY				
1995	ESSEX	ESSEX	YORKS	ESSEX				
1996	ESSEX	LANCS	NOTTS	YORKS	MIDDX			
1997	ESSEX	LANCS	LANCS	CUMBRIA	HANTS			
1998	DURHAM	LANCS	NOTTS	LANCS	ESSEX			
1999	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	YORKS	CUMBRIA			
2000	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	SURREY	NOTTS			
2001	SURREY	LANCS	ESSEX	NOTTS	NOTTS			
2002	DEVON	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	CUMBRIA			
2003	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	YORKS	CUMBRIA		
2004	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	YORKS	CUMBRIA		
2005	HERTS	LANCS	LANCS	LANCS	LANCS	NOTTS		
2006	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	ESSEX	KENT	NOTTS		
2007	ESSEX	LANCS	SURREY	ESSEX	KENT	NOTTS		
2008	ESSEX	LANCS	SURREY	ESSEX	KENT	YORKS		
2009	HERTS	CHESH	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	YORKS		
2010	HERTS	ESSEX	LANCS	LANCS	KENT	KENT	CUMBRIA	
2011	GLOUCS	DERBYS	SURREY	LANCS	HANTS	HANTS	HANTS	
2012	GLOUCS	HERTS	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	NOTTS	
2013	CHESHIRE	HERTS	LANCS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	DORSET	
2014	LEICS	HERTS	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	DEVON	
2015	ESSEX	W. SCOT	SURREY	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	HANTS	
2016	ESSEX	HERTS	ESSEX	SURREY	SURREY	YORKS	KENT	
2017	ESSEX	ESSEX	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	YORKS	KENT	
2018	YORKS	HERTS	LANCS	LANCS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	
2019	ESSEX	HANTS	YORKS	YORKS	LANCS	SURREY	KENT	
2020	ESSEX	HERTS	ESSEX	ESSEX	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	
2021	NO COMPETITION DUE TO CORONA VIRUS							
2022	NO COMPETITION DUE TO CORONA VIRUS							
2023	LANCS	YORKS	HANTS	ESSEX	YORKS	SURREY	KENT	
2024	CAMBS	YORKS	HANTS	ESSEX	HANTS	SURREY	LANCS	
2025	CAMBS	YORKS	NOTTS	LANCS	YORKS	SURREY	SURREY	
2026	CAMBS	ESSEX	WORCS	HANTS	YORKS	SURREY	YORKS	KENT

The Badminton England Masters County Championships Past Winners

	Over 40	Over 45	Over 50	Over 55	Over 60	Over 65	Over 70	Over 75
2000	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	LANCS	NOTTS			
2001	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	KENT	CUMBRIA			
2002	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	KENT	CUMBRIA			
2003	DERBYS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	YORKS			
2004	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	YORKS	CHESHIRE		
2005	LANCS	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	HANTS	NOTTS		
2006	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	STAFFS	KENT	CUMBRIA		
2007	ESSEX	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	NOTTS		
2008	LANCS	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	HANTS	YORK		
2009	GLOUCS	ESSEX	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	CUMBRIA		
2010	CHESHIRE	ESSEX	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	KENT		
2011	CHESHIRE	LANCS	SURREY	LANCS	YORKS	HANTS		
2012	ESSEX	LANCS	YORKS	SURREY	SURREY	KENT	DORSET	
2013	GLOUCS	ESSEX	YORKS	SURREY	SURREY	HANTS	DEVON	
2014	ESSEX	ESSEX	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	DEVON	
2015	YORKS	ESSEX	YORKS	YORKS	LANCS	KENT	WILTS	
2016	ESSEX	ESSEX	ESSEX	SURREY	ESSEX	YORKS	KENT	
2017	YORKS	ESSEX	YORKS	SURREY	LANCS	LANCS	KENT	
2018	YORKS	GLOUCS	YORKS	ESSEX	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	
2019	YORKS	GLOUCS	ESSEX	ESSEX	SURREY	LANCS	KENT	
2020	NO FINALS DUE TO CORONA VIRUS							WILTS
2021	NO COMPETITION DUE TO CORONA VIRUS							
2022	STAFFS	GLOUCS	HANTS	ESSEX	SURREY	LANCS	LEICS	KENT
2023	CAMBS	SUSSEX	HANTS	ESSEX	YORKS	LANCS	ESSEX	KENT
2024	STAFFS	YORKS	NOTTS	ESSEX	YORKS	SURREY	SURREY	KENT
2025	ESSEX	YORKS	NOTTS	HANTS	YORKS	LANCS	YORKS	KENT
2026	CAMBS	YORKS	NOTTS	HANTS	YORKS	LANCS	LANCS	KENT

TEAM OVER 40/45/50/55/60/65/70/75

FIXTURES 2026/27

Date	Against	Venue	Start time	Result	Score

Remember

9/10 th January 2027	Challenge weekend
4 th April 2027	Championship play offs
24/25 th April 2027	Championship Finals weekend